Class 7 Social Science – Chapter 9

From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

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इस अध्याय में सरकार के कार्य, लोकतंत्र के सिद्धांत, सरकारों के विभिन्न प्रकार और लोकतंत्र का महत्त्व समझाया गया है। नीचे आपकी PDF के आधार पर simple English में topic-wise important questions and answers, textbook exercise answers, और अतिरिक्त परीक्षा-उपयोगी प्रश्न-उत्तर दिए गए हैं।

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1. What is Government?

Q1. What is a government?

Answer: A government is a system or group of people that runs a country and makes decisions for its people.

Q2. What are the main functions of a government?

Answer: The main functions of a government are:

1. To maintain law and order.
2. To protect the country from external attacks.
3. To maintain peace, stability and security.
4. To manage relations with other countries.
5. To provide education, healthcare and infrastructure.
6. To manage the economy.
7. To work for the welfare of the people.

Q3. Why is government important in our lives?

Answer: Government is important because it maintains order, protects people, provides essential services and works to improve people's lives.

Q4. What are the three duties of a ruler mentioned by Kautilya?

Answer: Kautilya mentions three duties:

- Rakṣha: Protecting the state from external attacks.
- Pālana: Maintaining law and order within the state.
- Yogakṣhema: Safeguarding the welfare of the people.

Q5. What is national defence?

Answer: National defence means protecting a country from external threats and attacks.

2. What is Democracy?

Q1. What is democracy?

Answer: Democracy is a form of government in which the people are the source of power and authority. It is also called the “rule of the people.”

Q2. Explain Abraham Lincoln's definition of democracy.

Answer: Abraham Lincoln described democracy as “government of the people, by the people, for the people.”

- Of the people: The government belongs to the people.
- By the people: People choose their representatives.
- For the people: The government should work for the welfare of the people.

Q3. How does the school committee example explain democracy?

Answer: The school committee example shows that students can elect representatives from their classes. These representatives discuss students' needs and help make decisions. Similarly, in a democracy, people elect representatives to govern them.

Q4. Why is electing representatives better than allowing everyone to manage every task directly in a large school or country?

Answer: It is difficult for everyone to discuss and decide every issue together. Elected representatives can discuss issues, make decisions and represent the needs of the people.

Q5. What is a representative?

Answer: A representative is a person chosen to act or make decisions on behalf of another person or group.

3. Functions of Government

Q1. What are the three main functions of government?

Answer: The three main functions are legislative, executive and judicial.

Q2. What is the legislative function?

Answer: The legislative function is the function of making laws and rules for the country.

Q3. What is the executive function?

Answer: The executive function is the function of implementing laws and administering the country according to them.

Q4. What is the judicial function?

Answer: The judicial function is concerned with deciding disputes, interpreting laws and ensuring that laws are followed.

Q5. Why does a government need all three functions?

Answer: A government needs to make laws, implement them and ensure that they are followed fairly. These three functions help a country run properly.

4. What Makes Governments Different?

Q1. What are the four major questions that help us compare governments?

Answer:

1. Who gives the government its power and authority?
2. How is the government formed?
3. What are the different parts of the government, and what do they do?
4. What goals and values does the government work for?

Q2. What is a constitution?

Answer: A constitution is a set of fundamental rules that explains how a country is governed and how its government should work.

Q3. How is a democratic government usually formed?

Answer: A democratic government is usually formed through elections in which people choose their representatives.

Q4. How is a monarchy usually formed?

Answer: In a monarchy, the position of the ruler usually passes from one member of the royal family to another.

Q5. Why are governments different in different countries?

Answer: Countries have different histories, cultures, traditions and goals. Therefore, their governments may have different structures and ways of working.

Q6. What is the source of authority in a democracy and a theocracy?

Answer: In a democracy, the people are the source of authority. In a theocracy, religious beliefs and religious authorities are the main source of authority.

5. Fundamental Principles of Democracy

Q1. What are the fundamental principles of democracy?

Answer: The fundamental principles of democracy include equality, freedom, representative participation, universal adult franchise, protection of fundamental rights and an independent judiciary.

Q2. What is equality in a democracy?

Answer: Equality means that every person should be treated equally before the law. Everyone should also have equal access to facilities such as education and healthcare.

Q3. What is freedom in a democracy?

Answer: Freedom means that citizens can make their own choices and express their opinions within the limits of the law and respect for others' rights.

Q4. What is representative participation?

Answer: Representative participation means that people elect representatives to speak and make decisions on their behalf.

Q5. What is universal adult franchise?

Answer: Universal adult franchise means that every adult citizen who meets the legal voting requirements has the right to vote, without unfair discrimination.

Q6. What are fundamental rights?

Answer: Fundamental rights are basic rights protected by the Constitution. Examples include the right to equality and the right to freedom of speech and expression.

Q7. What is an independent judiciary?

Answer: An independent judiciary is a system of courts that can make decisions fairly without improper pressure from the government or other powerful groups.

Q8. Why is an independent judiciary important in a democracy?

Answer: It protects people's rights, ensures that laws are followed and helps prevent the misuse of government power.

Q9. When did India introduce universal adult franchise?

Answer: India provided universal adult franchise from the beginning of the Indian Republic in 1950.

Q10. When did women get the right to vote in Switzerland, according to the chapter?

Answer: Women got the right to vote in Switzerland in 1971.

6. Different Forms of Democratic Government

A. Direct Democracy

Q1. What is direct democracy?

Answer: Direct democracy is a form of government in which citizens directly participate in making decisions and deciding rules.

Q2. What is one limitation of direct democracy?

Answer: It is difficult to practise direct democracy in a large country because it is hard for every citizen to take part in every decision.

Q3. Where are some forms of direct democracy practised today?

Answer: Some forms of direct democracy are practised in Switzerland.

B. Representative Democracy

Q4. What is representative democracy?

Answer: Representative democracy is a form of government in which people elect representatives to govern on their behalf.

Q5. What is accountability in a democracy?

Answer: Accountability means that the government is answerable to the people who elected it.

Q6. Why are elections important in representative democracy?

Answer: Elections allow people to choose their representatives and change them if they are not satisfied with their work.

Q7. How often are general elections held in India, according to the chapter?

Answer: General elections in India are normally held every five years.

C. Parliamentary Democracy

Q8. What is parliamentary democracy?

Answer: Parliamentary democracy is a form of democracy in which the executive is drawn from the legislature and remains in office as long as it has the legislature's confidence.

Q9. How does parliamentary democracy work in India?

Answer: People elect members of Parliament. The Prime Minister and Council of Ministers lead the government and are accountable to Parliament. The Council of Ministers must retain the confidence of the Lok Sabha to continue in office.

Q10. What is the role of the Prime Minister in India?

Answer: The Prime Minister leads the government and the Council of Ministers. The Prime Minister coordinates government work and helps implement its policies.

D. Presidential Democracy

Q11. What is presidential democracy?

Answer: Presidential democracy is a form of government in which the executive works independently of the legislature. The president is elected through the country's prescribed election system and does not need the legislature's confidence to remain in office.

Q12. Give an example of a presidential democracy.

Answer: The United States of America is an example of a presidential democracy.

Q13. What is the main difference between parliamentary and presidential democracy?

Answer: In parliamentary democracy, the executive depends on the confidence of the legislature. In presidential democracy, the executive works independently of the legislature.

Comparison: Parliamentary and Presidential Democracy

Parliamentary democracy	Presidential democracy

The executive is drawn from the legislature.	The executive works independently of the legislature.
The government must retain the legislature's confidence.	The president does not need the legislature's confidence to remain in office.
Example: India	Example: USA

7. Legislature, Executive and Judiciary

Q1. What is the legislature?

Answer: The legislature is the organ of government responsible for making laws. In India, it is called Parliament.

Q2. What is the executive?

Answer: The executive is the organ of government responsible for implementing laws and running the administration.

Q3. What is the judiciary?

Answer: The judiciary is the system of courts that interprets laws, decides disputes and protects people's rights.

Q4. What are the Upper House and Lower House in India?

Answer: The Upper House is the Rajya Sabha, and the Lower House is the Lok Sabha.

Q5. What is separation of powers?

Answer: Separation of powers means that the legislature, executive and judiciary perform their functions independently, with appropriate checks on each other.

Q6. What is the difference between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha?

Answer: The Lok Sabha is the Lower House, whose members are directly elected by the people. The Rajya Sabha is the Upper House, which represents the states and union territories and is formed mainly through indirect elections, along with nominated members.

Q7. What is the difference between Parliament and the government?

Answer: Parliament is the national legislature that makes laws and holds the government accountable. The government, led by the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, implements laws and runs the administration.

8. Early Republics in India

Q1. What is a republic?

Answer: A republic is a form of government in which the head of state is elected and is not a hereditary monarch.

Q2. What was the Vajji Mahajanapada known for?

Answer: The Vajji Mahajanapada, particularly the Lichchhavi clan, was known for collective decision-making. Leaders were chosen based on merit rather than birth, and representatives met to discuss issues.

Q3. Why are some ancient Indian states called early republics?

Answer: They are called early republics because leaders were chosen through collective processes and representatives took part in decisions instead of power passing only through a royal family.

Q4. What do the Uttaramerur inscriptions tell us?

Answer: The Uttaramerur inscriptions from the Chola period in Tamil Nadu describe elections to the village sabha. They provide information about election procedures, members' qualifications, duties and conditions for dismissal.

Q5. How do the Uttaramerur inscriptions show accountability?

Answer: They describe rules for selecting members and removing those who failed to meet the required standards or were involved in corruption. This shows that local administration had rules and accountability.

9. Monarchy

Q1. What is a monarchy?

Answer: A monarchy is a form of government ruled by a king or queen, usually called a monarch.

Q2. What is a hereditary monarchy?

Answer: A hereditary monarchy is one in which the position of monarch usually passes from one member of the royal family to another.

Q3. What is absolute monarchy?

Answer: An absolute monarchy is a form of government in which the monarch holds almost all governing power, including major control over law-making, law enforcement and justice.

Q4. Give an example of an absolute monarchy mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Saudi Arabia is given as an example of an absolute monarchy.

Q5. What is a constitutional monarchy?

Answer: A constitutional monarchy is a form of government in which a king or queen is the head of state, but their powers are limited by the constitution and the system of government.

Q6. Give an example of a constitutional monarchy.

Answer: The United Kingdom is an example of a constitutional monarchy.

Q7. What is the difference between absolute and constitutional monarchy?

Answer: In an absolute monarchy, the monarch holds most governing power. In a constitutional monarchy, the monarch's powers are limited, and elected institutions exercise the main governing powers.

Q8. What is rajadharma?

Answer: Rajadharma means the duties and moral responsibilities of a ruler. It includes ruling justly, following dharma and protecting the welfare of all people.

Q9. What qualities should a good ruler have, according to the chapter?

Answer: A good ruler should be fair, protect people's welfare, apply laws without bias, avoid pride and corruption, and seek advice from wise people.

10. Theocracy

Q1. What is a theocracy?

Answer: A theocracy is a form of government in which religious rules and religious leaders have a central role in governing the country.

Q2. Give examples of theocracies mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: The chapter mentions Iran, Afghanistan and Vatican City. It also explains that Iran combines theocratic and democratic elements in its political system.

Q3. How is a theocracy different from a democracy?

Answer: In a democracy, the people are the source of political authority and choose representatives. In a theocracy, religious beliefs and religious authorities have a central role in the source and exercise of power.

11. Dictatorship

Q1. What is a dictatorship?

Answer: A dictatorship is a form of government in which one person or a small group holds absolute power without effective limits imposed by a constitution or law.

Q2. Who was Adolf Hitler?

Answer: Adolf Hitler was the dictator of Germany. He eliminated opposition, promoted racist ideas and was responsible for the Holocaust and the outbreak of the Second World War.

Q3. What was the Holocaust?

Answer: The Holocaust was the systematic persecution and murder of six million Jews by Nazi Germany and its collaborators, along with the persecution and killing of other groups.

Q4. Who was Idi Amin?

Answer: Idi Amin was a military dictator of Uganda who was responsible for the killing of thousands of people. Many people, including people of Indian origin, were forced to flee Uganda during his rule.

Q5. Why is dictatorship harmful to people?

Answer: A dictatorship can suppress freedom, silence opposition, violate rights and concentrate power in the hands of one person or a small group.

Q6. Does Shane's country in the chapter appear to be democratic? Why?

Answer: No. Shane's country does not appear to be democratic because the government controls many parts of daily life, restricts access to information and closely watches people's activities. People have little freedom to make their own choices.

12. Oligarchy

Q1. What is an oligarchy?

Answer: An oligarchy is a form of government in which a small, powerful group makes the important decisions. This group may consist of wealthy families or influential people.

Q2. What does the word “oligarchy” mean?

Answer: The word comes from Greek. Oligos means “few,” and arkhō means “to rule” or “to command.”

Q3. Can a democracy show signs of oligarchy?

Answer: Yes. A democracy may show signs of oligarchy if a small group of wealthy or powerful people gains too much influence over political decisions.

Q4. How can people prevent democracy from becoming an oligarchy?

Answer: People can vote responsibly, demand transparency, oppose corruption, protect independent institutions and ensure that elected representatives remain accountable.

13. Why Does Democracy Matter?

Q1. Why is democracy considered a better form of government?

Answer: Democracy allows people to choose their government, express their opinions and enjoy fundamental rights. The government is accountable to the people and can be changed through elections.

Q2. How does democracy protect people's freedom?

Answer: Democracy allows people to express their views, choose their beliefs, decide what to wear and make personal choices, as long as they respect the rights of others.

Q3. What are the major challenges faced by democracy?

Answer: Major challenges include corruption, inequality in wealth, excessive influence of powerful groups, weakening of judicial independence and the spread or manipulation of information.

Q4. How can citizens help strengthen democracy?

Answer: Citizens can vote responsibly, stay informed, question the government, oppose corruption, respect others' rights and protect democratic institutions.

Q5. Can democracy have problems even when elections are held?

Answer: Yes. Elections alone do not guarantee a strong democracy. People also need freedom, equality, fair laws, an independent judiciary and an accountable government.

Q6. How does democracy improve people's lives?

Answer: Democracy gives people a voice in government. It encourages the government to protect rights, provide essential services and work for the welfare of all citizens.

14. Textbook Exercise – All 8 Questions

The following answers are based on the questions on pages 207–208 of your PDF.

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Question 1. Write the names of the various types of government that you have learnt in the chapter.

Answer: The main types and forms of government discussed in the chapter are:

1. Direct democracy
2. Representative democracy
3. Parliamentary democracy
4. Presidential democracy
5. Monarchy
6. Theocracy
7. Dictatorship
8. Oligarchy
9. Republic

Note: A republic describes a system in which the head of state is not a hereditary monarch. It can also be democratic.

Question 2. Which type of government does India have? Why is it called that type?

Answer: India has a representative parliamentary democracy. It is called a representative democracy because people elect representatives through elections. It is called a parliamentary democracy because the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers are drawn from the legislature and remain in office while they have the confidence of the Lok Sabha.

Question 3. Give three reasons why an independent judiciary is important.

Answer:

1. It protects the fundamental rights of citizens.
2. It ensures that laws are followed by citizens and government institutions.
3. It helps prevent the misuse of power and provides fair decisions in disputes.

Question 4. Do you think democratic government is better than other forms of government? Why?

Answer: Yes, I think democracy is generally better because people can choose their representatives and change the government through elections. It protects freedom and equality and allows people to express their opinions. The government is accountable to the people and

should work for their welfare. However, democracy needs active and responsible citizens to overcome problems such as corruption and inequality.

Question 5. Match each practice with the correct type of government.

Practice	Correct answer
I. All citizens are treated equally before the law.	Democracy
II. The government refers to religious leaders for decisions.	Theocracy
III. After the queen's death, her son becomes the new king.	Monarchy
IV. The ruler is not bound to follow a constitution and makes decisions as he wishes.	Dictatorship

Question 6. Find the types of government in these countries.

The textbook asks you to identify the type of government in Bhutan, Nepal, Bangladesh, South Africa and Brazil. These are model answers based on their present constitutional systems.

Country	Type of government
Bhutan	Constitutional monarchy
Nepal	Federal democratic republic
Bangladesh	Parliamentary republic
South Africa	Parliamentary republic
Brazil	Federal presidential republic

Question 7. What are the possible hurdles in a democracy? How can they be overcome?

Answer: Democracy can face several hurdles, such as corruption, inequality, excessive influence of wealthy people, manipulation of information and weakening of the judiciary.

These problems can be reduced through free and fair elections, transparent government decisions, strong independent institutions, equal opportunities, responsible media and active public participation. Citizens should stay informed, follow the law and hold elected representatives accountable.

Question 8. Explain how democracy is different from monarchy and dictatorship.

Answer: In a democracy, people choose their representatives through elections, and the government is accountable to them. Citizens enjoy rights and freedoms protected by law.

In a monarchy, a king or queen is the ruler, and the position usually passes through the royal family. In an absolute monarchy, the monarch holds extensive power, while in a constitutional monarchy, the monarch's powers are limited.

In a dictatorship, one person or a small group holds concentrated power, and people have limited opportunities to challenge the government. Freedom and opposition may be suppressed.

15. Textbook Activities – Model Answers

Activity A: Page 188 – Which method is best for forming a school committee?

Answer: The third method is best. Students from each grade should elect their representatives through voting. This method allows every grade to express its needs, and the representatives can discuss issues and make decisions for the whole school.

Activity B: Page 196 – Core principles of a democratic government

Answer:

- Equality
- Freedom
- Representative participation
- Universal adult franchise
- Protection of fundamental rights
- An independent judiciary
- Accountability of the government

Activity C: Page 196 – Plan a democratic student committee

Answer:

1. Decide the duties of the committee.
2. Invite students to nominate candidates.
3. Allow each class to elect its representatives through fair voting.
4. Count the votes transparently.
5. Assign responsibilities to the elected members.
6. Hold regular meetings and listen to students' concerns.
7. Review the committee's work and hold members accountable.

Activity D: Page 199 – What might happen if a king believed he had divine powers?

Answer: A king who believed he had divine powers might think that nobody could question his decisions. He could misuse his power and ignore people's needs. A good ruler should act fairly, follow the principles of rajadharma and work for the welfare of the people.

Activity E: Page 204 – What does the oligarchy cartoon show?

Answer: The cartoon suggests that although members of an elected body may be elected by the people, wealthy and powerful groups may influence their decisions. It warns that political power can become concentrated in the hands of a few people.

Activity F: Page 204 – Can a democracy turn into an oligarchy?

Answer: Yes. It can happen when a small group of wealthy or influential people gains too much control over political decisions. Citizens can help prevent this by voting responsibly, demanding transparency, opposing corruption and protecting independent institutions.

Activity G: Page 205 – Complete the comparison of government types

The table below follows the general comparison presented in the textbook. Real countries may differ, particularly constitutional monarchies and systems with mixed features.

Characteristic	Democracy	Dictatorship	Absolute monarchy	Oligarchy
Universal adult franchise	Yes	No	No	No
Equality among citizens	A key principle	Not guaranteed	Not guaranteed	Not guaranteed
Freedom of speech	Protected in a genuine democracy	Often restricted	Not guaranteed	May be restricted
Separation of powers	Supported by democratic principles	Often weak	Often weak	Often weak
Wellbeing and prosperity of all citizens	A key goal	Not guaranteed	Not guaranteed	Not guaranteed

Activity H: Page 206 – Which form of government is most suitable?

Answer: Democracy is generally the most suitable form because it gives citizens a voice in government, protects their rights and allows them to change their representatives through elections. It also encourages equality, freedom and accountability.

16. Important One-Mark Questions for Revision

Question	Simple answer
1. What is democracy?	Rule of the people.
2. What is a representative?	A person chosen to act for others.
3. What is a constitution?	The fundamental rules of a country.
4. What is a republic?	A system in which the head of state is not a hereditary monarch.

5. What is a monarchy?	Government ruled by a king or queen.
6. What is a theocracy?	Government in which religion and religious leaders play a central role.
7. What is a dictatorship?	Government in which one person or a small group holds absolute power.
8. What is an oligarchy?	Government controlled by a small, powerful group.
9. What is universal adult franchise?	The right of adult citizens to vote.
10. What is accountability?	Being answerable for one's actions.
11. What is separation of powers?	The independent functioning of the legislature, executive and judiciary.
12. What is the legislative function?	Making laws.
13. What is the executive function?	Implementing laws.
14. What is the judicial function?	Interpreting laws and deciding disputes.
15. What is rajadharma?	The duties and moral responsibilities of a ruler.
16. What is the Lower House of India's Parliament called?	Lok Sabha.
17. What is the Upper House of India's Parliament called?	Rajya Sabha.
18. What is India's form of government?	Representative parliamentary democracy.
19. Who described democracy as “government of the people, by the people, for the people”?	Abraham Lincoln.
20. What is the main purpose of an independent judiciary?	To protect rights and ensure fair application of the law.

17. Important 3–5 Mark Questions

Q1. Explain the three functions of government.

Answer: The government has three main functions. The legislature makes laws. The executive implements laws and manages administration. The judiciary interprets laws, decides disputes and protects people's rights. Together, these functions help the country run properly.

Q2. Explain the fundamental principles of democracy.

Answer: Democracy is based on equality, freedom and participation. Citizens should be treated equally before the law and should have the freedom to express their opinions. They elect representatives through elections. Universal adult franchise gives adult citizens the right to vote. Fundamental rights and an independent judiciary protect citizens from the misuse of power.

Q3. Differentiate between democracy, monarchy and dictatorship.

Answer: In a democracy, people elect representatives and can change the government through elections. In a monarchy, a king or queen usually inherits the position through the royal family. In a dictatorship, one person or a small group holds concentrated power, and people may have little freedom to challenge the government.

Q4. Why is democracy important for citizens?

Answer: Democracy allows citizens to choose their leaders, express their opinions and participate in public life. It protects fundamental rights and makes the government accountable. If the government does not perform well, people can elect new representatives. Democracy also encourages equality and aims to improve the welfare of all citizens.

Q5. What are the challenges to democracy, and how can citizens overcome them?

Answer: Democracy faces challenges such as corruption, inequality, misinformation and excessive influence by wealthy groups. Citizens can help overcome these challenges by voting responsibly, staying informed, demanding transparency, respecting different opinions and protecting independent institutions.

18. Final Quick Revision

Remember these key points before your examination:

- Government: Runs the country and provides essential services.
- Democracy: Rule of the people.
- Legislature: Makes laws.
- Executive: Implements laws.
- Judiciary: Interprets laws and decides disputes.
- Universal adult franchise: The right of adult citizens to vote.
- Representative democracy: People elect representatives.
- Parliamentary democracy: The executive depends on the confidence of the legislature.
- Presidential democracy: The executive works independently of the legislature.
- Monarchy: A king or queen rules, usually through hereditary succession.
- Theocracy: Religious rules and authorities have a central role in government.
- Dictatorship: Power is concentrated in one person or a small group.
- Oligarchy: A small, powerful group makes major decisions.
- Republic: The head of state is not a hereditary monarch.
- Why democracy matters: It protects rights, allows public participation and makes the government accountable.

These notes cover the chapter's main topics, textbook exercise questions and important additional questions in simple English for Class 7 revision.